[EDWARD BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Tehran, February 19, 1852*

I am very much gratified to perceive that you take much interest, in my paper or rather the government Gazette managed by me. I was afraid that my writing in every letter about the paper might become tiresome; you are quite right in observing that the carrying on such a publication requires much caution, particularly with regard to the foreign news which I publish, otherwise England Russia or Turkey, the three governments with which Persia has most to do, might complain, give trouble to the government and get me into a mess. I have however gone on very well as yet and the longer the thing goes on the better I, and those employed under me, carry on the routine of the business.

My illness which I perhaps foolishly mentioned to you last autumn was nothing at all serious and has now left me, but after trying almost all the European medecines such as rhubarb magnesia soda etc without much success I found much benefit from the Persian treatment viz astringent acids particularly pommegranites and I now continue taking this delicious fruit occasionally although I have little occasion for it medecinally.

We are expecting another attaché to the Mission which I shall be glad of as we are so few English we are always glad of an addition to our party. Col Farrant now in England on leave will also most likely be back during the summer.

I should like you to see Sheffea Khan, the Persian Chargé d'affaires in London. He is not here considered a clever man, and never before held a higher place than that of Lt Colonel (unattached) and every one was much surprised at his being named Chargé d'affaires and that at such a court as London. I believe I told you in a former letter that my friend in his mission is Meerza Ibrahim the interpreter. I think it is probable that Sheffea Khan may now be recalled, his great protector was the late Ameer i Nizaum (the Prime Minister) and it is not likely this government will go on paying between three and four thousand pounds a year for a Chargé d'affaires at London when they can very well do without one. The Persian Government have also sent an expensive mission to St Petersburgh, this they will probably continue at least for some time to come.

My wife is quite well and sends her duty. I have found out that she is a good horse-woman for the other day as we were riding out, I proposed going to a place called Cheshma Allee a pretty place where there is an abundant spring of pure, clear, water gushing out from under a rock, and abounding with fish, and forgetting that ladies were not in the habit of riding across country I took a straight line and we had some little ditches to get over which she jumped beautifully.

Generated on 2020-09-16 01:50 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112419
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN